

RULES FOR

The Great Australian Game

SQUATTER®

(THE OWNER OF A LARGE LIVESTOCK FARM)

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This exciting family game, for two to six Players, is based on actual livestock farming principles. The usual playing time ranges from 1 hour to 2½ hours. But a much quicker game can be achieved by increasing Players' initial capital. (Rules for a quick game page 16)

Object of the Game

Each Player starts with a Sheep Station, consisting of five Natural Pasture paddocks, fully stocked with 3,000 sheep.

The object of the game is to improve the Station, in order to stock more sheep, first by paying the cost of "Improved Pasture" and then by paying for the cost of "Irrigated Pasture".

The first Player to have 6,000 sheep on his/her completely irrigated farm is the Winner.

The money needed to improve the Station, to buy the extra sheep and to cover other expenses is earned mainly:-

- (a) From the profit resulting from the Player's shrewd selling and buying of sheep.
- (b) By the sale of wool from sheep owned by the Player at the time he/she reaches the "Wool Sale".

Description of the Playing Board

Each of the six Sheep Stations consists of five paddocks.

The Orange spaces each represent a Natural Pasture paddock.

The Green spaces each represent an Improved Pasture paddock.

The Blue spaces each represent an Irrigated Pasture paddock.

The coloured spaces around the four sides of the playing board represent the four seasons of the year. The main seasonal tasks connected with the running of a Sheep Station, and some of the hazards, are shown.

The end of the farming year is marked by the Wool Sale, when the Player with sheep receives his/her Wool Cheque.

Equipment

One Playing Board, one Rules Book, one Ready Reckoner, two Dice, six Haystack cards, six Players Tokens, six Drought Marker discs, 180 Sheep Tokens (each representing one pen of 200 sheep), 30 Stock Sale cards, 25 Tucker Bag cards, five Stud Ram cards, five Worm Control Programme cards, five Fertilized Pasture cards, five Control of Weeds/Insects cards, 30 Improved Pasture cards, 30 Irrigated Pasture cards and one set of Play Money representing \$10,000, \$5,000, \$1,000, \$500, \$100, \$50, \$20, \$10, \$5 and \$1 notes.

The Game in Play

Place the cards marked "Tucker Bag" and "Stock Sale" face downwards on the Spaces provided on the playing board. Place the "Tucker Bag" card marked "Fire Fighting Equipment" on top of the "Tucker Bag" cards.

Select a Player to act as Banker.

Each Player selects a coloured token and is given 15 Sheep tokens (each of which represents one Pen, of 200 Sheep) and \$2,000 cash made up as follows:-

3	\$500's.....	\$1,500
2	\$100's.....	\$200
5	\$50's.....	\$250
4	\$10's.....	\$40
2	\$5's.....	\$10
		\$2,000

NOTE. - A much quicker game can be achieved by giving each Player one \$5,000 note and one \$1,000 note (\$6,000).

Each Player selects a Station Property and places 600 Sheep on each of the five Natural Pasture paddocks, i.e., three Sheep tokens on each of his/her five orange spaces.

All Players' tokens are placed on the space marked "Wood Sale" which is the starting point.

Players throw the dice in turn. The Player scoring the highest total commences the play.

After throwing the two dice, he/she moves his/her token the number of spaces indicated by the total of the dice in the direction of the Arrow.

The other Players in turn throw the dice, and move their tokens accordingly.

As each Player lands on a space he/she must follow the instructions indicated on that space, or refer to the Rules for instructions when these are not shown on the playing board.

Each time a Player with sheep passes the space marked "Wool Sale" he/she receives a Wool Cheque from the Bank. The amount of the Wool Cheque is determined by the number of Sheep which the Player owns at this time. The value of the wool increases by \$25 per pen for each "Stud Ram" owned by the Player. (Refer to Wool Sale Chart for quick calculations).

If a Player does not own any Sheep, other than "Stud Rams" at the time he/she passes the "Wool Sale", he/she does not collect a Wool Cheque.

Note. - Any number of Players' tokens may be on the same space at the one time. Players are permitted only one throw of the dice each turn; Doubles do not entitle a Player to a second throw.

Maximum carrying Capacities of the Property

A Player cannot own more than five Paddocks at any one time, irrespective of the type of Pasture.

Natural Pasture (Orange Spaces) 600 Sheep (three Sheep tokens) per Paddock.

Improved Pasture (Green Spaces) 1,000 Sheep (five Sheep tokens) per Paddock. (Cost of Pasture \$500 for each Green Space).

Irrigated Pasture (Blue Spaces) 1,200 sheep (six Sheep tokens) per Paddock. (Cost of Pasture \$1,500 for each Blue Space).

Property Improvement

A Player can only purchase Improved Pasture or Irrigated Pasture immediately before his/her turn to throw the dice, subject to the following conditions:-

Improved Pasture -

Can be purchased when a Player has sufficient cash, provided he/she is not affected by Drought at the time. The cost of each Improved Pasture Paddock (Green Space) is \$500.

A Player may purchase any number of Improved Pasture Paddocks (from one to five).

The Bank issues a Green Improved Pasture Card for each Green Space purchased.

The Player then moves any Sheep tokens on the Natural Pasture Paddocks

which have been improved, onto the corresponding Improved Pasture Paddocks.

The Player may also move down Sheep tokens from any remaining Natural Pasture Paddocks, to gain higher selling prices at the "Stock Sales". However, the carrying capacity of the Improved Pasture Paddocks must not be exceeded.

Note. - It is not essential to have Stock on Natural Pasture Paddocks before buying Improved Pasture, nor is it essential to have Stock on Improved Pasture before buying Irrigated Pasture.

Irrigated Pasture -

May be purchased after the Player has purchased a total of five Improved Pasture Paddocks, provided he/she is not affected by a Drought at the time. The Cost of each Irrigated Pasture Paddock (Blue Space) is \$1,500.

The Player receives a Blue Irrigated Pasture Card for each Irrigated Pasture Paddock he/she purchases.

Any Stock (ie Sheep tokens) on the Improved Pasture Paddocks which have been Irrigated must be moved down accordingly.

Stock Sale

If a Player's token lands on a space marked 'STOCK SALE' he/she has one of three choices:-

- (a) He/she can BUY Stock (provided his/her property is not already fully stocked - Refer Maximum Carrying Capacity and Local Drought).
- (b) He/she can SELL Stock.
- (c) He/she can take no action, in which case he/she says "Pass".

If a Player decides to BUY or SELL Stock, **he/she must announce firstly the number of Pens to be bought or sold.**

15 Pens is the maximum number of Sheep that can be bought or sold at any one time.

The Player then turns over the top "Stock Sale" card to find out the price, then

replaces this card on the bottom of the Stack. (Use Chart provided to determine total amount).

Note 1.

- Sheep can only be bought or sold when the Player's token is on a "Stock Sale" (unless otherwise directed) and then only to, or from, the Bank.

Note 2.

- Each Stock Sale card shows a different Buying Price, and two different Selling Prices. A Selling Price for Stock on Natural Pasture, and a Higher Selling Price for Stock on either Improved or Irrigated Pasture.

In most instances, the Selling Price is much higher than the Buying Price. Players taking advantage of this fact can usually make a good profit by selling or buying several pens of sheep at a time, up to the maximum number allowed, each time they land on a "STOCK SALE".

Stud Ram

Each "Stud Ram" owned by a Player increases the value of his/her Wool Cheque by \$25 per Pen.

The first Player whose token lands on a "Stud Ram" space has the option of buying that particular one for the sum of \$500. He/she receives a "Bill of Sale" to indicate Ownership. In the event of a Player deciding not to buy a "Stud Ram" it is auctioned by the Bank to the highest bidder. The Player who decides not to purchase a Stud Ram for \$500 may participate in the Auction.

Other Players, whose tokens land on this "Stud Ram" on all subsequent occasions, must pay the Owner the Stud fees shown.

Stud Ram Dies

If a Player owning one or more "Stud Rams" lands on this space, he/she must return the Stud Ram with highest Stud Fee to the Bank. This Ram then becomes available for sale in the usual way.

Tucker Bag

If a Player lands on a space marked "Tucker Bag" he/she takes the top "Tucker Bag" card, follows the instructions then replaces this card on the bottom of the Stack (unless directed otherwise).

Bore Dries Up

(only affects Player with "Irrigated Pasture")

If a Player who owns "Irrigated Pasture" lands on the space marked "Bore Dries Up" he/she must immediately sell to the Bank one half of any Stock on Irrigated Pasture at that time. (If an odd number of Pens, calculate to the next highest number).

The Price paid by the Bank is \$300 per Pen, unless a Haystack is owned.

If the Player owns a Haystack, the Bank pays \$500 per Pen, however, the Haystack must be returned to the Bank. The Player must complete a full circuit of the Board before re-stocking, unless his/her property receives local or general rain. Landing on flood damage does not remove this penalty.

Drench Sheep for Worms

If a Player who owns sheep land on this space, the Player has one of two alternatives:

- The Player may pay the minimum cost of \$10 per Pen, for each Pen of Sheep owned at the time or,
- The Player may carry out a proper Worm Control Programme at a cost of \$20 per Pen, for each Pen of Sheep owned at the time, gaining the following benefit:

The Player who pays the charge of \$20 per Pen is given a card labelled "Worm Control Programme". The next time this Player sells stock the price of any sheep he/she sells is increased by 20%. The "Worm Control Programme" card is then returned to the Bank.

Spray for Weeds and Insects

Any Player landing on this space must pay the amount indicated, i.e., \$100. In return the Player receives from the Bank a Card labelled "Control of Weeds and Insects". When a Player next sells stock, the price of any sheep he/she sells is increased by 20%. The "Control of Weeds and Insects" Card is then returned to the Bank.

Pay Cost of Fertilizer

Any Player landing on this space must pay \$250 to the Bank. In return the Player receives from the Bank a card labelled "Fertilized Pasture".

When the Player next sells stock, the price of any sheep he/she sells is increased by 20%. The "Fertilized Pasture" Card is then returned to the Bank.

Note. - A Player's selling price can be increased by 40% or 60% or more if he/she receives a number of cards, such as "Fertilized Pasture", before he/she sells stock. If a Player is forced to sell Stock for some reason such as Local Drought, etc., the Player still receives 20% more than the stipulated price, for each "Worm Control Program", "Control of Weeds and Insects", or "Fertilized Pasture" Card held at the time.

Local Drought

When a Player lands on this space, he/she must immediately sell to the Bank one half of any Stock he/she may have on "Natural Pasture" or "Improved Pasture" at that time. (If an odd number of Pens, calculate to the next highest figure).

Stock on Irrigated Pasture are not affected by Local Drought

If the Player does not own a Haystack, the price paid by the Bank is \$200 per Pen.

If a Haystack is owned, the Player turns up the next "Stock Sale" card to find out his/her selling price.

A Player cannot re-stock on "Natural" or "Improved" Pasture nor can he/she buy "Improved" or "Irrigated" Pasture (even if a Haystack is owned) during the period he/she is affected by the Drought. (He/she can, however, buy or sell Stud Rams during this period).

The duration of the Drought is for one complete circuit of the board, unless it is broken by the Player landing on the space marked "Local Rain", or by the Player turning up the "Tucker Bag" card marked "Local Rain" or "General Rain" or "Good Autumn and Spring Rains". Landing on Flood Damage does not break the Drought.

Additional Stock may be sold from Natural or Improved Pasture, if a Player lands on a Stock Sale during the period of a Drought, however the price is half normal price. (Refer Stock Sale cards for Prices).

A "Drought Marker" disc, the same colour as the Player's token, is placed on the board to show the commencing point of the Drought.

If a Player lands on another "Local Drought" space when he/she is already affected by a Drought, the period of the Drought is extended.

In this case, however, the Player need not sell any more stock, nor need the Player forfeit another Haystack, should he/she have purchased one of these in the meantime.

Local Rain

If a Player who is affected by Drought lands on this space, the Drought becomes "Broken" on his/her property only, and the Player may carry out Property Improvements, and re-stock when he/she lands on the next "STOCK SALE". If a Player is not affected by Drought, or if the Player's Bore had not dried up, he/she does not receive any benefit.

Haymaking Season

When a Player lands on any of the six spaces included in the "Haymaking Season", the Player can purchase a Haystack.

The normal cost of a Haystack is \$500 and a Player can only hold one Haystack at any one time.

Once a Haystack has been purchased, it remains effective until a Player needs it to offset the effect of a "Local Drought", or "Bore Dries Up", when it becomes "used".

If a Player has no Stock on "Natural" or "Improved" Pasture at the time he/she becomes affected by Drought, the Haystack need not be returned to the Bank. If a Player "uses" his/her Haystack, the Player can buy another one the next item he/she lands in the Haymaking Season.

A Haystack can be purchased during the period when the Player is affected by a Drought, but it does not offset the effects of that Drought. If a Player buys a Haystack when he/she is affected by a Drought, the cost is \$1,000.

Note. - Haystacks can only be bought from the Bank.

Sundry Working Expenses

If a Player lands on any of the spaces listed hereunder, the Player must pay to the Bank the amount shown, for each Pen of Sheep owned at that time. (If the Player does not have any stock other than Stud Rams at the time, he/she does not make any payment to the Bank).

Sheep dipping	Drench for Liver Fluke
Drench Sheep for Worms	Vaccinate for Pulpy Kidney
Jet Sheep against Fly-Strike	Shearing Costs
Footrot Treatment	

(Use Chart provided for quick calculation of the total payment due to the Bank).

If the Player lands on any of the following spaces, the amount shown must be paid to the Bank, whether or not the Player owns any Stock at the time.

Flood Damage	Spray for Weeds and Insects
Fencing Repairs	Pay Cost Fertilizer
Control of Vermin	Water Drilling Expenses

Working Capital

If a Player runs short of cash and needs more, the Player may sell one or more Pens of Sheep to the Bank for \$400 per Pen. He/she need not wait for a Stock Sale in this instance.

When a Player is reduced to 8 Pens of Sheep (or less) he/she may then borrow money from the Bank by mortgaging part or all of his/her property.

Mortgage Rates for the Property are as follows-

Natural Pasture.....	\$100 per Paddock
Improved Pasture.....	\$250 per Paddock
Irrigated Pasture.....	\$750 per Paddock

Mortgaged property can be fully stocked, but until the loan is repaid, the Player must pay to the Bank 10% interest on the money loaned, each time the Player passes the Wool Sale.

Before a Player can win the Game, any mortgaged property must be redeemed by payment to the Bank of the money loaned, plus an additional 10%.

Stud Rams can be sold at any time (to the Bank) for \$400 each. The Stud Ram then becomes available to the next Player landing on the appropriate space.

A *Haystack* can also be sold at any time (to the Bank only) for \$350.